MODULE 35 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL SECTIONS

What changed since the exam guide

Every rename, every legacy-versus-recommended shift, and how to answer when the exam and the docs use different words.

SECTION All sections EXAM WEIGHT - MODULE 35 of 40

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Answer in the exam's world. Work in today's. **A different name is not a different product, and a newer way is not automatically the answer.**

Products with new names

THE GUIDE SAYS	NOW CALLED	SINCE
Vector Search	Databricks AI Search	June 2026
Genie Spaces	Genie Agents	July 2026
Mosaic AI Agent Framework	Agent Bricks Custom Agents	February 2026
Multiagent Supervisor	Supervisor Agent	2026
AI Gateway	Unity AI Gateway	2026
Databricks Asset Bundles	Declarative Automation Bundles	16 March 2026

ON THE EXAM

Every one of these is a rename, not a replacement. The concepts the exam tests are unchanged.

Old names that survive in APIs and classes

STILL SAYS	WHERE
`/api/2.0/vector-search/...`	AI Search REST paths
`DatabricksVectorSearch`	LangChain retriever class
`DatabricksVectorSearchIndex, DatabricksGenieSpace`	Agent resource classes
`spaces and space_id`	Genie Conversation API
`databricks.vector_search imports`	Older docs and notebooks
`databricks bundle commands, unchanged`	Bundle CLI

ON THE EXAM

Renames rarely reach every path at once. The Python SDK is now databricks.ai_search, but older names keep working.

Names you may expect to change, but have not

- **Information Extraction** keeps its name, as an Agent Bricks builder paired with ai_extract.
- **Document Intelligence** is a marketing umbrella for the SQL document functions, not a rename.
- **Knowledge Assistant**, MLflow and Unity Catalog keep their names.
- **Model services**, in Beta, add a naming layer in system.ai for hosted models.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> When unsure whether something was renamed, fall back on the concept. The exam tests what a feature does.

Recommended now, and still examined

AREA	RECOMMENDED NOW	OLDER, STILL EXAMINED
Agent interface	ResponsesAgent	ChatAgent, ChatModel
Hosting new agents	Databricks Apps, AgentServer	Model Serving
Evaluation	mlflow.genai.evaluate, @scorer	mlflow.evaluate, @metric
Model versions	Aliases in Unity Catalog	Stages in the workspace registry
External API tools	MCP Services, connections proxy	UC functions calling http_request
Logged traffic	Gateway inference tables	Legacy inference tables

ON THE EXAM

Both columns work. The left is what Databricks now recommends. The right may still appear in questions written earlier.

Features that arrived or matured

FEATURE	STATUS
Priority pay-per-token	New serving mode
Provisioned throughput: on-demand or reserved	Reserved overflow spills to priority
Six gateway guardrail types, with Log mode	Public Preview
MLflow production monitoring	Beta
Review queues for human review	Beta
ABAC, governed tags, data classification	Generally available
DASF version 3.0, agentic component	Published 2026

ON THE EXAM

New features rarely appear in older exam items. They matter most for real work, and for newer questions.

The exam's world, or today's?

THE EXAM'S WORLD

The March 2026 guide

- Uses older product names
- Describes Model Serving deployment
- Questions test concepts
- Answer by the stated requirement

TODAY'S WORLD

The current docs

- Uses the new names
- Recommends Apps for new agents
- Adds new features and modes
- Use it for real projects

THE TIEBREAKER

An older name or older path in an option is not a reason to reject it. Decide by the requirement, exactly as before.

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A short calendar

- **16 March 2026**: Asset Bundles become Declarative Automation Bundles.
- **18 March 2026**: the current exam guide goes live.
- **June and July 2026**: AI Search and Genie Agents renames.
- **30 September 2026**: the Supervisor API reaches end of life. The Supervisor Agent does not.
- **2 October 2026**: Gemini 2.5 models retire. Retirement notice is three months.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The Supervisor API and the Supervisor Agent are different products. Only the API is ending.

When a name looks unfamiliar

01
Map
Translate the name to the concept.

02
Ignore the label
Old or new, it is the same product.

03
Find the requirement
What does the scenario need?

04
Apply the tiebreaker
The one you learned for that concept.

05
Choose
The option that meets it.

ON THE EXAM

The renames change the words, not the reasoning. Every tiebreaker in this course still applies.

> An exam option reads: create a Delta Sync index on a Vector Search endpoint, with managed embeddings.
>
> You studied the same feature under the name Databricks AI Search.

What should you conclude about this option?

A. The option is outdated, so it must be one of the distractors

B. It refers to a separate legacy product that has been retired

C. It is the same product under its former name, so judge it on merit

D. Vector Search now supports only Direct Vector Access indexes

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should you conclude about this option?

A Outdated, so a distractor

The exam itself uses the guide's names.

B A retired product

Nothing was retired. It was renamed.

C Same product, judge on merit

A rename, not a replacement.

D Direct Access only

Invented. Delta Sync remains the usual choice.

THE SIGNAL

Vector Search is AI Search. Map the name, then judge the option by the requirement.

> A question asks how to deploy an agent built with the Agent Framework, so that applications can call it through a governed endpoint.
>
> You know Databricks now recommends Databricks Apps for new agents.

Which answer fits the question as written?

A Log it with MLflow, register it in Unity Catalog, deploy to Model Serving

B It cannot be deployed, since Model Serving no longer supports agents

C Convert it into a Knowledge Assistant first, then deploy that instead

D Export the agent's code and host it on a third-party web server

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which answer fits the question as written?

A MLflow, Unity Catalog, Model Serving
The path the guide describes, and still supported.

B Cannot be deployed
False. Model Serving still serves agents.

C Convert to Knowledge Assistant
A different builder, for a different job.

D Third-party server
Loses the governed endpoint the question asks for.

THE SIGNAL

Legacy for new agents does not mean unsupported. In the exam's world, this is the deployment path.

> A team runs a Supervisor Agent that coordinates a Genie Agent and a Knowledge Assistant.
>
> It reads that the Supervisor API reaches end of life on 30 September 2026, and plans an urgent rebuild.

What should the team do about its Supervisor Agent?

A. Rebuild it all as a custom orchestrator before that date

B. Merge its subagents into one single Knowledge Assistant

C. Stop using Genie subagents, since they rely on that API

D. Nothing: the Supervisor Agent is a separate, GA product

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do about its Supervisor Agent?

A Rebuild as custom

Solves a problem the team does not have.

B Merge into one assistant

Loses Genie's table answers.

C Drop Genie subagents

Genie does not depend on the Supervisor API.

D Nothing: a separate GA product

Only the beta Supervisor API is ending.

THE SIGNAL

Supervisor API is not Supervisor Agent. Similar names, different products, different fates.

What to carry forward

- Renames: **AI Search**, **Genie Agents**, **Custom Agents**, **Supervisor Agent**, **Unity AI Gateway**, **DABs**.
- Old names survive in code. They are not wrong.
- Recommended now: ResponsesAgent, Apps, @scorer, aliases, MCP. Older paths still work.
- Answer in the exam's world; decide by the requirement, not by newness.
- Supervisor API ends 30 September 2026. Supervisor Agent does not.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next: module 36 puts every confusable pair from the course side by side.